

Example Corp Data Classification and Handling Policy

Document owner: IT Security. Version 1.5, effective 1 March 2026. Applies to all information created, received, or processed by Example Corp and its contractors.

Classification levels

Level	Description	Examples
Public	Approved for release outside the company	Marketing material, published job adverts, press releases
Internal	For employees and contractors; low impact if disclosed	Internal announcements, most policies, project plans without client data
Confidential	Would cause harm to Example Corp, a client, or an individual if disclosed	Client contracts, financial results before publication, employee records, source code
Restricted	Would cause severe harm; access limited to named individuals	Credentials and keys, security incident reports, merger and acquisition material, health data

When in doubt, classify one level higher and ask the information owner.

Labelling

Confidential and Restricted documents carry the level in the header or footer. Emails containing Confidential or Restricted content carry the level in the subject line in square brackets, for example [Confidential].

Handling rules

Activity	Internal	Confidential	Restricted
Storage	Company systems	Company systems, encrypted at rest	Approved systems only, encrypted, access logged
Sharing outside the company	Not allowed	Only under a signed agreement, encrypted in transit	Only with written approval of the information owner and IT Security
Printing	Allowed in the office	Office only, collect immediately, shred after use	Not allowed
Personal devices and	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed

Activity	Internal	Confidential	Restricted
accounts			
Public generative AI tools	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed

Approved storage locations are the corporate document management system, the corporate cloud drive, and the source code repositories. Removable media is not permitted for Confidential or Restricted data.

Retention and disposal

- Financial and tax records are retained for **seven years**. Contracts are retained for seven years after they end. Recruitment records of unsuccessful candidates are deleted after four weeks unless the candidate agrees to a longer period.
- Records that reach the end of their retention period are deleted securely. Paper is shredded; devices are wiped before reuse or disposal.

Personal data

Personal data is at least Confidential. Processing must have a lawful basis and be recorded in the processing register kept by Legal. Data subject requests are handled within one month.

Reporting

Suspected disclosure of Confidential or Restricted information is a security incident and must be reported immediately to `security@example.corp`, following the IT Incident Response Procedure.